

Committed to developing infrastructure and social sector: Bhupinder Singh Hooda

In his second term as the Haryana Chief Minister, Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda is more committed to development. He wishes to take Haryana further on the road to development and social justice. The Chief Minister is confident of honouring his commitments. In a wide-ranging interview with *Rajiv Kapur*, he spoke about the basic issues he would address during his current tenure.

A ruling party has returned to power only for the second time in Haryana's electoral history. What are your views on it?

We thank the people for reposing faith in the Congress and giving their mandate in favour of peace, development and welfare policies of our party, which our government had been pursuing for the last four-and-a-half years. I am grateful to Congress president Sonia Gandhi for showing confidence in my leadership. I assure you that with good governance and by accelerating the pace of development, I will meet the expectations of people.

Though the number of seats we have won is not according to our expectations, still it is a historic victory. After the 1972 elections, whichever ruling party went to the polls, it received a drubbing at the hands of the people. In this election, we are the single largest party with 40 seats. The polling registered an all-time high percentage, breaking the previous record of 1967.



What will be your thrust areas?

During my last tenure, we had inherited an administration in which there had been lawlessness and chaos and we had to work with utmost sincerity and dedication to put development activities back on track. During this term, the pace of development will be further accelerated. A people-friendly administration is the hallmark of good governance. We re-affirm our commitment to further improving the delivery mechanism at the cutting edge level. The redressal of public grievances will be made more effective by using modern information technology.

The priorities of my government are sound infrastructure coupled with a vibrant social sector. We will make Haryana an educational hub, create more avenues of employment by accelerating industrialisation, besides stepping

up agricultural production. Adequate and improved health facilities for all will again be my government's top priority. As in the previous term, we will focus on uniform development of the state.

What is your vision for the next five years?

We will continue to follow the dictum of making Haryana a frontrunner in every field. On the infrastructure front, on Haryana Day, we have initiated a massive programme of construction and upgradation of roads and buildings, for which a provision of Rs 1,600 crore has been made for immediate expenditure. The programme will not only change the face of rural areas, but also create ample job opportunities. Nearly 6,000 kilometres of road-length, mostly rural, will be widened and strengthened. More than 1,000 kilometres of new road links will